

The Story of Mel

Lookup the Story of Mel to get a dose of what "real programming" is all about - writing applications without SDKs or IDEs and interfacing directly with the hardware

Code Monkey

"Code Monkey" is a pejorative term for a person who churns out coding without any vision for the software he is making.

that I am consulted about computer and mobile phones in my locality."

Gaurav Tarey

Gaurav Tarey is one of the more active members on the forums, who has coded a Firefox extension to make the experience on the ThinkDigit Forums better. This add-on has been enthusiastically received by the forum members. Gaurav checks his pm on the forum more often than his inbox. He is known by the username Tarey_g on the forums.

We asked him why he came up with the Firefox extension. "Someone once told me that things need not to be complex and big to be useful, I realised it when I started making small applications and one of them was the 'NeatDigit' extension for the forum. It was a very simple 20 lines of code I made myself to enhance the Digit forum browsing experience; I shared it on the forum and was overwhelmed that many members

belonging to developer community should try and make practical applications which interest them. This is the best way to learn, because nothing beats the enthusiasm to see your app working, eagerness to learn more and to make it better. I have learned many new things over the course of last 2 years since I first shared the 'NeatDigit' extension, and now when I look back in my code I see many things that were entirely wrong (stupid) or could have been done in a better way.

This is a win, because when you think what you have done can be improved means you have become more proficient. I am currently rewriting the 'NeatDigit' forum extension and lines of code have dropped down to half, same applies to my few other applications.

Digit readers do amazing stuff, and with internet getting social day by day it's very easy to share. You can make the website you always wanted or an app for your smartphone. Create and share and the best place to start is sharing it with your Digit family." **d**

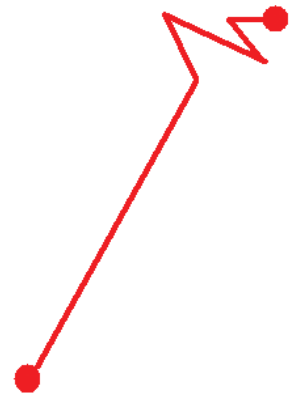
Lomash Gupta

Lomash Gupta goes by the username Aspire on the Digit Forums, and he has programmed an application that adds a number of features to Chrome. He enjoys developing applications, and he explains why he spends his free time coding: "It helps you think about how everyday processes work - there is nothing like building your own applications to make you think logically about how people behave online, and the hidden sophistication of seemingly simple systems like cash machines or website subscription services. Coding is also good for your attention to detail and organisational skills - you can be sloppy about how you capitalise words or use punctuation in the real world, but the world of code makes you a more organised, consistent person. Coding lets you translate ideas into prototypes, talk is cheap, but if you can turn it into a prototype, you're already a step ahead - and you can refine your thinking as you build it and get feedback on something tangible, rather than just a brainwave. Coding

opens up a new world of lifehacks you can build for yourself, whether it's a way to backup your Twitter account or a to-do list application that actually reflects how you work, being able to write bits of code to save yourself time is neat. It's creative and relaxing, I don't actually get paid to code, so for me there's something relaxing and challenging in sitting down to make a new tool or improve something. It's good from a career perspective, even a small amount of coding ability would give you a plus point on your CV."

There are many more members of the Digit community who actively develop applications that are not featured here. We are reserving some space on our DVDs for content created by our readers and mem-

CRACK THE CODE



bers of the Digit community. In the Community DVD, there are other applications and content sent to us by readers such as yourself. Inside, you will find a version of the Digit Software Archive using Ajax instead of the .NET framework was created by Manas Kumar, a reader. There is also a video review of the iPad, mailed to us by Ankush Das, another reader. Ramvijay Belkonikar has mailed in a demo he created using After Effects. Also included is a Digit Toolbar extension for Firefox, created by ThinkDigit Forum member, gopi_vboy. The developer's section of the forum is a great place to start learning to code. If you want to share an application, demo, video, music, or any other original content, mail in download links or attached files to DVD@thinkdigit.com. **d**



Gaurav Tarey

found it useful. Now the extension has gone through many iterations with even more useful and fun additions, all because of the active inputs from Digit members. When you develop something for yourself or a close community like 'ThinkDigit', there is too much to learn and it never gets boring. I think everyone